Lesson 2 Teacher's Checklist / Prep Guide

Complete before Thursday, August 20, 2026

VIDEO GAME CREATION

Self-Contained Lesson Assets

Per Lesson Production Standards Rule 3, nothing this lesson needs should require a student to search for or download something mid-class. Everything below is already prepared and included in this lesson's Assets folder - no download required.

- ☐ Placeholder sprite pack already generated (player_circle_blue.png, player_circle_green.png, player_circle_orange.png, player_arrow_white.png, player_walk_spritesheet.png) - copy into each engine's project as needed.
- ☐ Placeholder sound effect already generated (sfx_blip.wav) for students who want to try the Level 3 "add a sound" idea in Scratch, GameMaker, GDevelop, TIC-80, 001 Game Creator, or Unreal.
- ☐ Copy the Assets folder onto the shared classroom drive / USB backups alongside the handouts so it travels with the rest of the lesson's materials.
- ☐ Confirm Unreal's Blank template still ships with basic Shape actors (Cube/Sphere) in the Place Actors panel for the optional advanced-track exercise - no separate download needed there either.

Engine Verification

- ☐ Confirm the demo laptop's Hello World still works for all 8 engines (ref: Engine Installation & Hello World Guide) - re-run any that haven't been touched in a few weeks.
- ☐ Pre-build the full Scratch Key Press Reactor exercise (all 3 levels) on the demo laptop so you have a finished example ready to show.
- ☐ Godot: confirm Project Settings > Input Map still has the default ui_up/ui_down/ui_left/ui_right actions unmodified, and practice the Set As Main Scene step on main.tscn once so it's a familiar click during class.
- ☐ Unity: confirm Edit > Project Settings > Player > Other Settings > Active Input Handling is set to "Both" (the default for a fresh Unity 6 project) or "Input System Package (New)" - the Lesson 2 code uses Keyboard.current, which needs one of those two, not "Input Manager (Old)" alone.
- ☐ GameMaker: quick-test that keyboard_check(vk_right) etc. work in a throwaway object before class.
- ☐ GDevelop: confirm the "Top-down movement" behavior is available when adding a behavior to an object in your installed version.

- ☐ TIC-80: confirm btn(0-3) map to Up/Down/Left/Right as expected on your keyboard.
- ☐ 001 Game Creator (Windows demo laptop): confirm the Input Triggers window and Position Actor / Take Movement in Direction events are accessible.
- ☐ If any advanced-track students are on Unreal this week, confirm the editor still opens and Blueprints compile cleanly, and practice the Auto Receive Input step on BP_Player once so it's a familiar click during class.

Materials

- ☐ Print or queue digital copies of all 8 Student Handouts (or confirm students can access their engine's version electronically).
- ☐ Have the 8 Teacher's Keys on hand (instructor reference only - do not distribute) in case a student needs a worked example beyond Level 1.
- ☐ Have Lesson 1 sign-in / install notes handy to know who still needs setup help at the start of lab.
- ☐ Bring: demo laptop, projector cable/adapter, handout copies, Assets folder (on USB as backup), any offline installers still needed.

Known Gotchas This Week

- GameMaker: movement code goes in the Step event, not Draw - students may default to Draw out of habit from the Lesson 1 Hello World exercise.
- Godot: if a student's sprite doesn't move, the most common cause is the script being attached to the wrong node, or the scene not being saved before running. A second, separate snag this week: forgetting to drag Player into main.tscn, or forgetting to set main.tscn as the project's Main Scene - F6 on player.tscn alone still "works" for movement testing either way, which can hide this mistake until Lesson 3 needs Player and Bullet sharing one running scene.
- 001 Game Creator: dialog field layouts can vary slightly by version - if something looks different from the handout, the Script Editor and Actor wiki pages have the current layout.
- Unreal: this is the heaviest engine on our list - if a student's laptop is struggling, it's fine for them to observe this week's demo and build the exercise in a lighter engine instead.
- Unreal: the single most common "nothing happens, no error" cause this week is forgetting to set Auto Receive Input to Player 0 in BP_Player's Class Defaults - since BP_Player is a plain Actor rather than a possessed Pawn, it never receives keyboard input without this step, and every Enhanced Input Action Event will silently just never fire.